

# Acqlerate Growth Plan

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From clicks to conversions — what to fix, in order

April 2026 — based on live campaign data

# The Diagnosis

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## What's working

The campaign data is actually encouraging. At **\$1.02 CPC**, you're well within efficient range for B2B LinkedIn ads. Project Managers are clicking at **4.35% CTR** — that's exceptional. VP and CXO seniority levels are at 2–3%+ CTR, which means the right decision-makers are responding. Madrid and Barcelona show 1.3% CTR with good resonance. The product-market fit signal is there in the click data.

**6,449** impressions | **65** clicks | **1.01%** CTR | **\$1.02** CPC | **0.9%** audience penetration

## The real problem

**0 conversions** isn't a traffic problem. It's a measurement problem.

LinkedIn has no Insight Tag installed on acqlerate.com, so it can't see what happens after someone clicks. It's optimizing for clicks and calling it done. GA4 is installed (G-SW42SFY999) but has no conversion events beyond pageview. You could double the budget tomorrow and get the exact same conversion result: zero — because nobody is counting.

**Every dollar spent is driving clicks that disappear into a black hole.** More traffic budget won't help until conversions are tracked.

## The priority order

Fix measurement first. Then fix the audience. Then fix the ad creative. Then scale. This document walks through each step in order, with time estimates and exact instructions.

1. **Install LinkedIn Insight Tag** — 30 minutes
2. **Configure GA4 conversion events** — 1 hour
3. **Fix audience targeting** — 15 minutes
4. **Launch ad creative variants** — 2 hours
5. **Blog SEO improvements** — ongoing

# 01 Install LinkedIn Insight Tag

Time estimate: 30 minutes

The LinkedIn Insight Tag is a JavaScript snippet that tracks what visitors do after clicking your ad. Without it, LinkedIn optimizes for clicks — not sign-ups. Installing it is the single highest-leverage 30 minutes you can spend.

## Step-by-step

1. Go to **LinkedIn Campaign Manager** → Account Assets → Insight Tag
2. Copy the global site tag (a `<script>` snippet)
3. Add it to the `<head>` of `landing.html` and the React app's `index.html`
4. Create a **Conversion Action**: "Sign Up" — trigger on /app URL containing "register" or "auth"
5. Switch campaign objective from **"Website Visits"** to **"Website Conversions"**

### Why this matters

LinkedIn will now optimize ad delivery toward the people in your 65-click pool who actually **sign up**, not just anyone who clicks. The algorithm needs this signal to find more people like your converters. Expected result: same budget, more sign-ups.

### Verification

After installation, go to Campaign Manager → Account Assets → Insight Tag. The status should show **Active** within 24 hours. Use the LinkedIn Pixel Helper Chrome extension to verify it fires on page load.

# 02GA4 Conversion Events

Time estimate: 1 hour

GA4 is installed (G-SW42SFY999) but only tracks pageviews. That tells you how many people visit — not how many sign up, complete a lesson, or start a checkout. Adding conversion events unlocks GA4's Conversions report and shows which traffic sources actually produce users, not just visitors.

## Events to add

- **sign\_up** — Fire when `/api/auth/register` returns 200. This is your primary conversion event — the thing that matters most.
- **lead\_capture** — Fire when `/api/leads` returns 200. Tracks email captures from landing pages or contact forms.
- **lesson\_complete** — Fire when lesson progress saves. Tracks engagement depth — are users actually learning?
- **upgrade\_click** — Fire when Stripe checkout is initiated. Tracks commercial intent before payment.

## Implementation

Add these events using `gtag( 'event', ... )` calls in your JavaScript, triggered by the corresponding API success callbacks. Then in GA4 Admin → Events, mark `sign_up` and `lead_capture` as conversions.

### What this unlocks

GA4's **Conversions** report will show: which traffic sources produce sign-ups (LinkedIn ads vs. organic search vs. direct), which blog posts lead to sign-ups, which landing page variations convert, and the full user journey from first visit to registration.

## 03 Audience Exclusions

Time estimate: 15 minutes

The campaign data shows clear winners and losers in audience targeting. HR and Operations functions have low CTR and high CPC — they're consuming budget without converting. Cut them immediately and redirect that spend to segments that respond.

### Immediately exclude

- Human Resources function — low CTR, not the target buyer
- Operations function — low CTR, high CPC
- Any industry with 0 clicks after 500+ impressions — pure waste

### Add to targeting

- **Defense & Space** industry
- **Government Administration** industry
- **Program and Project Management** job title (not just function)
- **Military** job seniority

#### Estimated impact

**15–20% of current spend** redirected to high-CTR segments. With audience penetration at just 0.9%, there is massive room to grow within the segments that already respond. You're not running out of audience — you're wasting reach on the wrong people.

# 04Ad Creative Variants

Time estimate: 2 hours to write, 1 day to test

Currently running a single creative in boosted-post format. The algorithm can't optimize without multiple variants — LinkedIn needs 2–4 creatives to A/B test. Each variant below targets a different emotional angle. Launch all three and let LinkedIn find the winner.

## Variant A — The Question

**Headline:** "Do you know what type of contract you're on?"

**Body:** "Most defense professionals manage contracts they've never fully read. Acqlerate teaches you what actually matters — in plain English. Module 01 is free."

**CTA:** [Start Free](#)

## Variant B — The Stat

**Headline:** "The best PM I've worked with always read Section M first."

**Body:** "Before the SOW. Before Section C. Section M is the scoring rubric. This is the kind of thing Acqlerate teaches. Start with the free module."

**CTA:** [Read Free](#)

## Variant C — The Problem

**Headline:** "September 30th is not just the end of the fiscal year."

**Body:** "It's chaos. Every contracting office in DoD is drowning in expiring O&M. If you don't understand color of money, you're about to find out the hard way. Acqlerate — plain English DoD acquisition."

**CTA:** [Learn Free](#)

## Testing protocol

Set minimum **\$5/day per variant** to give LinkedIn enough data to optimize. Don't touch the campaign for 7 days — let the algorithm learn. After 7 days, check which variant has the highest CTR **and** conversions (not just clicks). Pause the losers, add their budget to the winner.

The blog has 32+ posts but is largely invisible to Google. Posts are technically competent but written in "AI voice" — formal, "So what?" headers, corporate tone that doesn't match the brand. More importantly, they lack the basic SEO infrastructure that Google needs.

Why blog posts aren't ranking

- No <meta name="description"> on individual blog posts
- No internal links from blog posts to relevant course modules
- No Article schema markup (structured data)
- Posts don't target long-tail defense acquisition search queries

Quick wins

1. Add <meta name="description"> to every blog post — 2–3 sentences including the target keyword.
2. Add **2 internal links per post** to the relevant module (e.g., a cost-plus article links to Module 02 Finance).
3. Add <script type="application/ld+json"> Article schema to each post for rich search results.
4. Target long-tail keywords that defense professionals actually search:

| Target keyword                    | Search intent     | Map to                 |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------|
| what is color of money DoD        | Informational     | Module on budget types |
| IDIQ vs task order                | Informational     | Contracting module     |
| defense contractor PM career path | Career/Commercial | Course overview        |
| FAR Part 15 source selection      | Technical         | Procurement module     |
| CPFF vs CPAF contract             | Informational     | Finance module         |

# 30-Day Priority Sequence

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## Week 1 Days 1–7: Measurement

- **Day 1:** Install LinkedIn Insight Tag on all pages
- **Day 2:** Switch campaign objective to Website Conversions
- **Day 3:** Add GA4 conversion events (sign\_up, lead\_capture, lesson\_complete, upgrade\_click)
- **Day 5:** Pause HR and Operations targeting; add Defense & Space industry
- **Day 7:** Verify conversion tracking is firing with LinkedIn Pixel Helper + GA4 DebugView

## Week 2 Days 8–14: Creative

- Write and launch 3 ad variants (copy provided in this document)
- Set minimum \$5/day per variant to let LinkedIn optimize
- Don't touch the campaign for 7 days — let the algorithm learn

## Week 3 Days 15–21: Organic

- Add meta descriptions to top 10 blog posts by topic relevance
- Add internal links from each post to corresponding course module
- Post first 3 LinkedIn organic posts from the social content pack

## Week 4 Days 22–30: Review

- Check which ad variant is winning (CTR + conversions, not just clicks)
- Pause losing variants, add their budget to the winner
- Check GA4 for first organic sign-up attribution
- Adjust LinkedIn audience based on 2 weeks of conversion data



# What Success Looks Like in 30 Days

Not vanity metrics. Real signals that the foundation is working:

- ✓ **LinkedIn Insight Tag firing on 80%+ of ad clicks**

Confirms tracking infrastructure is working. Without this, nothing else matters.

- ✓ **At least 1 tracked conversion from LinkedIn campaign**

Proves the measurement loop is closed. LinkedIn can now optimize toward sign-ups.

- ✓ **GA4 showing sign\_up events with source attribution**

You can finally see which channels produce users, not just visitors.

- ✓ **3 blog posts appearing in Google Search Console for target queries**

Organic pipeline is starting to build. These are free clicks that compound over time.

- ✓ **Cost-per-conversion under \$15**

Reasonable benchmark for niche B2C/B2G education product. If you hit this, the unit economics work.

## **What NOT to measure yet**

Don't optimize for ROAS, lifetime value, or funnel conversion rates in Month 1. You don't have enough data. Focus on getting the measurement infrastructure right. The optimization comes after you can see what's happening.

# Closing

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**The campaign data is actually encouraging.**

\$1.02 CPC. 4.35% CTR from Project Managers. The right seniority levels clicking. Madrid and Barcelona resonating. At 0.9% audience penetration, you've barely scratched the surface of a market that clearly responds to the product.

**The problem isn't that nobody wants this — it's that nobody's measuring whether they're signing up.**

**Fix the measurement first. The rest follows.**

## Priority recap

**1.** LinkedIn Insight Tag (30 min) → **2.** GA4 events (1 hr) → **3.** Audience cleanup (15 min) → **4.** Ad variants (2 hrs) → **5.** Blog SEO (ongoing)

Total setup time: approximately 4 hours. Expected payoff: finally being able to see — and optimize — what your ad spend actually produces.